

4 January 2019

Circular to Licensed Corporations and Associated Entities

Launch of revamped Business and Risk Management Questionnaire and new online portal

The Securities and Futures Commission (SFC) today issued a revamped Business and Risk Management Questionnaire (BRMQ)¹. Licensed corporations and associated entities are required to complete and electronically submit the new BRMQ to the SFC for financial years ending on or after 31 March 2019.

The new BRMQ should be completed within four months after the end of each financial year² and submitted electronically through [WINGS](#)³, the SFC's new online portal introduced below. For financial years ending before 31 March 2019, licensed corporations and associated entities should continue to complete the existing BRMQ and submit it in paper form⁴.

New BRMQ

Analysing the BRMQ is part of the SFC's risk-based supervision which tracks market demographics and monitors current trends and emerging issues. The new BRMQ aims to collect more information about the business operations of licensed corporations and associated entities as well as the specific measures adopted, including controls, policies and procedures, to ensure sound risk management and that business is conducted in a proper manner. This information will enable the SFC to carry out supervision of licensed corporations and associated entities more effectively.

The new electronic BRMQ contains new features including automated skip logic⁵, which directs respondents to the questions applicable to them. A "pre-population" function is also available to automatically fill in some of the answers submitted electronically for the previous financial year⁶.

WINGS – the new online portal

The SFC also launched today a new online portal, [WINGS](#), as a common platform for making electronic submissions to the SFC, including the new BRMQ. All functions and submission services available on the existing SFC Online Portal and other SFC systems will be migrated to WINGS in phases⁷.

¹ The electronic BRMQ is available here for [licensed corporations](#) and here for [associated entities](#).

² See section 156(1) of the Securities and Futures Ordinance (SFO) as amplified by the Securities and Futures (Accounts and Audit) Rules.

³ WINGS stands for Web-based INteGrated Service.

⁴ The [paper form](#) can be downloaded from the SFC's website.

⁵ Skip logic is an information technology feature that directs respondents to the next applicable question based on the answer selected.

⁶ When using the "pre-population" function, firms should ensure that the pre-populated answers remain accurate and valid for the present financial year. Alternatively, they may choose to start with a blank BRMQ without pre-populated answers.

⁷ Usernames and passwords for the SFC Online Portal can also be used to log in to WINGS.



The SFC is committed to making WINGS a user-friendly platform and we welcome suggestions on how it can be enhanced. Suggestions can be made by telephone at 2207 9333, or through e-mail to TechEnquiries@wings.sfc.hk.

Should you have any queries regarding the contents of this circular, please contact your case officer.

Intermediaries Supervision Department
Intermediaries Division
Securities and Futures Commission

End

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